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Mounting assembly for use with a plumbing fixture

Abstract

A mounting assembly for use with a plumbing fixture. The plumbing fixture is configured to be mounted within an opening in a body, such as a countertop or a sink surround. The mounting assembly includes, but is not limited to, a first portion that is configured to engage the plumbing fixture and to secure the plumbing fixture within the opening in the body. The mounting assembly further includes, but is not limited to, a second portion that is configured to be releasably coupled with the first portion.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The technical field relates generally to plumbing and more particularly relates to a mounting assembly for use with a plumbing fixture wherein the mounting assembly facilitates removal and replacement and/or exchange of the visible portions of the mounting assembly and associated hardware.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Plumbing fixtures that deliver water, for example, to sinks and tubs are mounted to such sinks and tubs or to counters and/or surrounds associated with such sinks and tubs, via mounting members that are associated with faucet assemblies. These faucet assemblies commonly include handles and spouts for operating the plumbing fixtures and dispensing the water. Conventionally, a plumbing fixture is fluidly coupled with a fluid source. In an example, the plumbing fixture includes a valve to control the flow of the fluid through the plumbing fixture. The valve permits the fluid to flow when the valve is opened and inhibits the fluid from flowing when the valve is closed.

The handles of such faucet assemblies are configured to be engaged with by the hand of a human operator at one end and to engage with the valve of the plumbing fixture at the other end. When a human operator rotates, manipulates, or otherwise operates the handle, the handle opens the valve and permits the fluid to flow through the plumbing fixture to the spout from which it is discharged into, for example, a sink.

(3) Conventionally, a plumbing fixture is positioned within an opening in a countertop, a sink, a tub, a surround or other surface and is secured by a mounting member that is associated with either the handle or the spout or both. In conventional embodiments, the mounting member comprises a decorative bezzel that is configured to mount a bottom portion of the handle or spout. In the case of a handle, the bezzel is rotationally coupled to the handle such that the handle can rotate with respect to the bezzel. In the case of a spout, the bezzel may or may not be configured to mount the spout in a non-rotating matter.

(4) To mount the plumbing fixture to the sink, the sink surround, the countertop, or to some other body, the bezzel includes threads along, for example, an inner diameter, and the plumbing fixture is placed in threaded engagement with the bezzel. The plumbing fixture includes a flange or other mounting feature that is designed to cooperate with the bezzel to mount the plumbing fixture to the countertop, sink, or other body. The bezzel is disposed on one side of the countertop, sink, sink surround, or other body while the mounting feature is disposed on the opposite side. When the plumbing fixture is screwed into the bezzel, the bezzel and the mounting feature compress against opposite sides of the countertop, sink, sink surround, or other body to mount the plumbing fixture within the opening of the body.

(5) From time to time, the bezzel, the handle and/or the spout may need to be removed and replaced. Conventionally, this involves unscrewing the bezzel from the plumbing fixture which entails undesirable complications. Such complications range from requiring the use of special tools, needing to reach into confined spaces, a person needing to place his or her body in awkward positions, and needing two or more workers in order to separate the bezzel from the plumbing fixture without damaging the plumbing fixture which would be free to fall through the opening once the bezzel is unscrewed and removed. While these concerns can be addressed by conventional means, there is room for improvement.

(6) Accordingly, it is desirable to provide an assembly that is configured to address one or more of the foregoing issues. Furthermore, other desirable features and characteristics of the various embodiments described herein will become apparent from the subsequent detailed description and the appended claims, taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings and this background.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(7) Various non-limiting embodiments of a mounting assembly for use with a plumbing fixture are disclosed herein. The plumbing fixture is configured to be mounted within an opening in a body. The various non-limiting embodiments of the mounting assembly are described below.

(8) In a first non-limiting embodiment, the mounting assembly includes, but is not limited to, a first portion that is configured to engage the plumbing fixture and to secure the plumbing fixture within the opening in the body. The mounting assembly further includes, but is not limited to, a second portion that is configured to be releasably coupled with the first portion.

(9) In a second, non-limiting embodiment, the mounting assembly includes, but is not limited to, a first portion that is configured to engage the plumbing fixture and to secure the plumbing fixture within the opening in the body. The mounting assembly further includes a second portion that is configured to be releasably coupled with the first portion. The mounting assembly still further includes, but is not limited to, a handle.

(10) In another non-limiting embodiment, the mounting assembly includes, but is not limited to, a first portion that is configured to engage the plumbing fixture and to secure the plumbing fixture within the opening in the body. The mounting assembly further includes, but is not limited to, a second portion that is configured to be releasably coupled with the first portion. In this non-limiting

embodiment, the second portion comprises a spout.

(11) Further areas of applicability will become apparent from the description provided herein. The description and specific examples in this summary are intended for purposes of illustration only and are not intended to limit the scope of the present disclosure.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) The drawings described herein are for illustrative purposes only of selected embodiments and not all possible implementations and are not intended to limit the scope of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 1 is a side view illustrating an exemplary aircraft suitable for use with embodiments of the mounting assembly of the present disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view illustrating an exemplary counter or surround suitable for use with embodiments of the mounting assembly of the present disclosure;

(4) FIG. 2A is a perspective view illustrating another exemplary embodiment of a sink or tub suitable for use with embodiments of the mounting assembly of the present disclosure;

(5) FIG. 3 is a schematic cross-sectional view illustrating two non-limiting embodiments of the mounting assembly of the present disclosure engaged with a plumbing fixture;

(6) FIG. 4 is a schematic cross-sectional view illustrating the mounting assemblies of FIG. 3 in a partially disassembled state ready to receive a new/replacement bezzle and faucet handle;

(7) FIG. 5 is an exploded view of the mounting assemblies of FIG. 3;

(8) FIG. 6 is a schematic cross-sectional view illustrating another non-limiting embodiment of the mounting assembly of the present disclosure engaged with a plumbing fixture; and

(9) FIG. 7 is a schematic cross-sectional view illustrating the mounting assembly of FIG. 6 partially disassembled and configured to receive a new/replacement spout.

(10) Corresponding reference numerals indicate corresponding parts throughout the several views of the drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(11) Example embodiments will now be described more fully with reference to the accompanying drawings.

(12) An improved mounting assembly is disclosed herein that addresses the concerns expressed above in the Background Section. In a non-limiting embodiment, the mounting assembly of the present disclosure uses two components to mount a plumbing fixture to a body such as a sink, a sink surround, a tub, a countertop or the like rather than a conventional mounting assembly that uses only a single component. Whereas the single component of a conventional mounting assembly serves both a decorative and a mechanical coupling function, the mounting assembly of the present disclosure assigns those two functions to two separate components. The mounting assembly disclosed herein includes a coupling portion that mechanically couples the plumbing fixture to the sink, surround or other body. The coupling portion is hidden from view by a visible portion when the mounting assembly is fully installed. The visible portion may have decorative or ornamental contours and/or features to create an aesthetically pleasing appearance. At the same time, the visible portion shields the coupling portion from dirt, grime, and other contaminants.

(13) The coupling portion is configured to engage the plumbing fixture, such as through threaded engagement, and to mount the plumbing fixture to a body such as a sink, a sink surround, a countertop or the like. The visible portion is configured to be releasably engaged with the coupling portion, to conceal the coupling portion, and in some embodiments, to engage with another component such as a faucet handle or a faucet spout. In some embodiments, the visible portion may comprise the faucet handle or the faucet spout. The releasable engagement between the visible portion and the coupling portion may be achieved through any suitable or conventional means such

as, but not limited to, the use of threaded fasteners.

(14) The releasable engagement between the visible portion and the coupling portion resolves the concerns expressed in the Background Section above. By being able to easily detach the visible portion from the coupling portion, a worker may replace the decorative/ornamental portions of a faucet assembly without any need to remove, dislocate, or otherwise disturb the plumbing fixture. Thanks to the plumbing fixture's undisturbed and continuous engagement with the coupling portion, the plumbing fixture remains statically in place and, in turn, undamaged while the decorative components of a faucet assembly are changed out or replaced on any number of occasions. This solution greatly facilitates the ability to update and renovate faucet assemblies or to simply replace them if they become damaged, corroded or otherwise decayed.

(15) In addition, the teachings of the present disclosure are not limited to only those sink assemblies where the spouts and the handles are separate components. Rather, the teachings of the present disclosure apply with equal force to faucet assemblies where the handle and the spout are combined into a single integrated component.

(16) A further advantage of the present invention is that no special tools or skills are required to change out the visible portion of the mounting assembly. Rather, an unskilled person using only a commonly available screwdriver is enabled by the mounting assembly disclosed herein to change out the visible portion of each and every faucet assembly in his/her dwelling without any special tools or training.

(17) A greater understanding of the mounting assembly discussed above may be obtained through a review of the illustrations accompanying this application together with a review of the detailed description that follows.

(18) FIG. 1 is a side view illustrating an exemplary aircraft **10** that is suitable for use with embodiments of the mounting assembly of the present disclosure. It should be understood that although embodiments of the mounting assembly disclosed herein are illustrated in the context of an aircraft, it should be understood that the mounting assembly is not limited to usage onboard an aircraft. Rather, it should be understood that the mounting assembly disclosed herein may be used onboard any vehicle that is configured to travel on land, air, sea, or outer space. Further, it should be understood that use of the mounting assembly disclosed herein is not limited to use in connection with a vehicle. Rather, the mounting assembly disclosed herein may be used in conjunction with plumbing fixtures in any and all applications where plumbing fixtures may be employed.

(19) With continuing reference to FIG. 1, FIG. 2 is a perspective view illustrating a sink **12**. Sink **12** may be associated with a galley and/or a lavatory onboard aircraft **10**. Sink **12** includes a faucet assembly **14** and a bowl **16**. Faucet assembly **14** includes a handle **18** and a spout **20**, as well as associated mounting assemblies (See FIGS. 3-7) and associated plumbing fixtures (see FIGS. 3, 5-7), discussed below. An operator may engage handle **18** by rotating it. Such rotation will actuate a valve in an associated plumbing fixture and cause fluid (e.g., water) to flow through spout **20** and dispensed into bowl **16**. In the illustrated embodiment, faucet assembly **14** is mounted in countertop **22** immediately adjacent to bowl **16**. Accordingly, countertop **22** is configured with openings to receive faucet assembly **14**.

(20) With continuing reference to FIGS. 1-2, FIG. 2A is a perspective view illustrating a sink **12'** which is an alternate embodiment of sink **12**. Sink **12'** differs from sink **12** in that sink **12'** includes a bowl **16'** having a surround **17** that is integral with bowl **16'**. Faucet assembly **14** is mounted into surround **17**. Accordingly, surround **17** is configured with openings that are configured to receive faucet assembly **14**. While FIGS. 2 and 2A illustrate the mounting assembly of the present disclosure employed in an application involving a sink, it should be understood that the mounting assembly of the present disclosure may also be employed in other plumbing applications including, but not limited to, bath tubs and shower stalls.

(21) With continuing reference to FIGS. 1-2A, FIG. 3 is a schematic cross-sectional view taken

across line 3-3 of FIG. 2. FIG. 3 illustrates handle **18**, a mounting assembly **24**, a mounting assembly **24'**, countertop **22**, and a plumbing fixture **26**. The various components illustrated in FIG. 3 have been illustrated in a manner that depicts gaps between the components. These gaps have been depicted for ease of illustration to better show the relationship between the components and to better show the contours of the components. It should be understood that in embodiments intended for implementation, the various components would be more tightly drawn up against one another and in some embodiments, would be in direct contact with one another.

(22) Mounting assembly **24** includes a mounting portion **30** (alternately referred to herein as a “first portion”) and a cover portion **32** (alternately referred to herein as a “second portion”). Mounting assembly **24'** includes mounting portion **30** (alternately referred to herein as a “first portion”), cover portion **32** (alternately referred to herein as a “second portion”), and handle **18**. In an exemplary embodiment, mounting portion **30** and cover portion **32** are constructed of a metal material. In other embodiments, mounting portion **30** and cover portion **32** may be constructed from any other suitable material that is effective to mount plumbing fixture **26** to countertop **22**.

(23) In the illustrated embodiment, mounting portion **30** and cover portion **32** each have an annular configuration. In other embodiments, mounting portion **30** and cover portion **32** may have any other suitable geometric configuration that is effective to mount plumbing fixture **26** to sink **12** or **12'**. In the illustrated embodiment, mounting portion **30** has a flat lower surface that is configured to rest in flush engagement with an upper surface of countertop **22** and that is further configured to nest within cover portion **32**. In this manner, when mounting assembly **24** is assembled to handle **18** and has mounted plumbing fixture **26** to countertop **22**, cover portion **32** will completely conceal mounting portion **30** from view. In some embodiments, cover portion **32** may serve a decorative purpose and may have an aesthetically pleasing contour/configuration that enhances the overall appearance of faucet assembly **14**. For example, cover portion **32** may have an outward appearance of a bezzle. In other embodiments, cover portion **32** may have a more utilitarian appearance. Regardless of its ornamental function, cover portion **32** protects mounting portion **30** from dirt, grime, and other contaminants.

(24) In the illustrated embodiment, plumbing fixture **26** comprises a valve assembly that is fluidly coupled with a water source via a conduit **34** and that is further configured to deliver water to spout **20** via conduit **36** when its valve (not shown) is open. Plumbing fixture **26** includes a valve stem **38** that is operatively coupled with the valve. In the illustrated embodiment, valve stem **38** may be actuated by rotation. Plumbing fixture **26** includes a plurality of threads **40** along an outer diameter that are configured to facilitate the mounting of plumbing fixture **26** to a body such as countertop **22**. Plumbing fixture **26** further includes a mounting flange **41** that further facilitates the mounting of plumbing fixture **26** to a body, as discussed below.

(25) A conventional bezzle serves two primary functions, those being to mount a plumbing fixture to a body (such as a sink or countertop) and to rotatably mount a handle in a position to engage the plumbing fixture. Mounting assembly **24** divides two functions and assigns them to two separate components. Mounting assembly **24** assigns the function of mounting a plumbing fixture to a body to mounting portion **30** and assigns the function of rotatably mounting a handle in a position to engage the plumbing fixture to cover portion **32**.

(26) As discussed above, mounting portion **30** has an annular configuration. Mounting portion **30** has an inner diameter having a plurality of threads **42** disposed along a surface defining its inner diameter. Plurality of threads **42** are configured to engage plurality of threads **40**. In this manner, mounting portion **30** can be screwed into threaded engagement with plumbing fixture **26**.

Countertop **22** has an opening that defines a hole **23**. In FIG. 3, plumbing fixture **26** is disposed within hole **23** and plurality of threads **42** are in threaded engagement with plurality of threads **40**. As mounting portion **30** and plumbing fixture **26** are screwed into threaded engagement with one another, mounting portion **30** and mounting flange **41** are pulled towards one another. As mounting portion **30** and mounting flange **41** are pulled towards one another, a lower surface of mounting

portion **30** and an upper surface of mounting flange **41** cooperate to compress countertop **22**. In this manner, mounting portion **30** mounts plumbing fixture **26** to countertop **22**.

(27) Cover portion **32** is configured to rotatably mount handle **18** to cover portion **32**. Methods by which handle **18** may be rotatably mounted to cover portion **32** are well known in the art and may be accomplished in any suitable or conventional manner that is effective to mount handle **18** over cover portion **32** in a manner that permits handle **18** to rotate with respect to cover portion **32**. When cover portion **32** is coupled with mounting portion **30**, valve stem **38** protrudes above an upper surface of cover portion **32**. Handle **18** includes a recess **44** that is configured to engage with valve stem **18** such that when handle **18** is rotated by a user, handle **18** causes the rotation of valve stem **38** which, in turn, actuates the valve in plumbing fixture **26** and permits water to flow from conduit **34** to and through conduit **36**.

(28) In the illustrated embodiment, cover portion **32** includes an opening **46** that extends laterally entirely through an outer wall of cover portion **32**. In addition, mounting portion **30** includes a cavity **48** that extends laterally into a wall of mounting portion **30**. Cavity **48** is disposed in a position that aligns with opening **46** when cover portion **32** is coupled with mounting portion **30**. In the illustrated embodiment, a mounting member **50** extends through opening **46** and into cavity **48**. In this manner, mounting member **50** affixes cover portion **32** with respect to mounting portion **30**. In some embodiments, cover portion **32** may include a plurality of openings **46** and mounting portion **30** may include a corresponding plurality of cavities **48** that are disposed to align with plurality of openings **46**. In such embodiments, a plurality of mounting members **50** may be employed to affix cover portion **32** in position with respect to mounting portion **30**. In some embodiments, mounting member **50** may comprise a threaded fastener, such as a flat head screw, a Phillips head screw, a hex head screw or the like, and either or both opening **46** and cavity **48** may include threads to engage with such threaded fastener. In other embodiments, any other suitable mechanism that is effective to retain cover portion **32** to mounting portion **30** may be used instead of the above described mounting member **50**. For example, and without limitation, retaining rings, pins or buttons may be employed.

(29) So long as mounting member **50** remains in place withing cavity **48**, cover portion **32** will remain affixed with respect to mounting portion **30**. If handle **18** or cover portion **32** ever become damaged or if for any other reason, an unskilled user decides to change out cover portion **32** and handle **18** (for example, to install a new cover portion and handle having a different appearance or a more pleasing ornamental design), then all that the unskilled user would need to do would be to remove mounting member **50** from cavity **48**. With mounting member **50** removed from cavity **48**, cover portion **32** and handle **18** may be decoupled from mounting portion **30**. When this occurs, mounting portion **30** remains in threaded engagement with plumbing fixture **26** and plumbing fixture **26** remains undisturbed during the changeout or replacement of cover portion **32** and handle **18**.

(30) With continuing reference to FIGS. 1-3, FIG. 4 is a schematic cross-sectional view illustrating the continued engagement between mounting portion **30** and plumbing fixture **26** and, consequently, the undisturbed mounting of plumbing fixture **26** to countertop **22**, after mounting member **50** has been removed from cavity **48** and both cover portion **32** and handle **18** have been separated from mounting portion **30**. This permits the plumbing fixture's fluid couplings to remain undisturbed during a change-out of decorative components. A new cover portion and a new handle may now be mounted to mounting portion **30** simply by positioning the new cover portion and handle over mounting portion **30** and re-inserting mounting member **50**. This can be accomplished by an individual who is not skilled in the art of conventional plumbing procedures. The various components illustrated in FIG. 4 have been illustrated in a manner that depicts gaps between the components. These gaps have been depicted for ease of illustration to better show the relationship between the components and to better show the contours of the components. It should be understood that in embodiments intended for implementation, the various components would be

more tightly drawn up against one another and in some embodiments, would be in direct contact with one another.

(31) With continuing reference to FIGS. 1-4, FIG. 5 is an exploded view of handle **18**, mounting assembly **24**, and mounting assembly **24'**. In this view, the annular configuration of both mounting portion **30** and cover portion **32** can be observed. Also observable in FIG. 5 are the plurality of threads **42** which are disposed along an inner wall that defines an inner diameter of mounting portion **30**.

(32) With continuing reference to FIGS. 1-5, FIG. 6 is a schematic cross-sectional view taken across line 6-6 of FIG. 2. FIG. 6 illustrates a mounting assembly **60**, spout **20**, countertop **22**, and a plumbing fixture **62**. The various components illustrated in FIG. 6 have been illustrated in a manner that depicts gaps between the components. These gaps have been depicted for ease of illustration to better show the relationship between the components and to better show the contours of the components. It should be understood that in embodiments intended for implementation, the various components would be more tightly drawn up against one another and in some embodiments, would be in direct contact with one another.

(33) Mounting assembly **60** includes a mounting portion **64** and spout **20** which, in the illustrated embodiment, also comprises the cover portion. In other embodiments, a separate component having the appearance of a bezzel, for example, may serve as the cover portion and spout **20** may be mounted to such separate component without departing from the teachings of the present disclosure. In an exemplary embodiment, mounting portion **64** and spout **20** are constructed of a metal material. In other embodiments, mounting portion **64** and spout **20** may be constructed from any other suitable material that is effective to mount plumbing fixture **62** to countertop **22**.

(34) In the illustrated embodiment, mounting portion **64** has an annular configuration while the cover portion, spout **20**, is configured as a spout for dispensing fluid. In the illustrated embodiment, mounting portion **64** has a flat lower surface that is configured to rest in flush engagement with an upper surface of countertop **22** and that is further configured to nest within spout **20**. In this manner, when mounting assembly **60** has mounted plumbing fixture **62** to countertop **22**, spout **20** will conceal mounting portion **64** from view. In some embodiments, spout **20** may serve a decorative purpose as well as a functional purpose. With this in mind, it may have an aesthetically pleasing contour/configuration that enhances the overall appearance of faucet assembly **14**. In other embodiments, spout **20** may have a utilitarian appearance. Regardless of its ornamental function, spout **20** protects mounting portion **64** from dirt, grime, and other contaminants.

(35) In the illustrated embodiment, plumbing fixture **62** performs a fluid mixing function. Plumbing fixture **62** is configured to receive a hot water stream and a cold water stream from other plumbing fixtures, combines the different water streams, and then routes the combined stream of water to spout **20**. Plumbing fixture **62** receives one stream of water from plumbing fixture **26** via conduit **36** and a second stream of water from a second plumbing fixture (not shown) via conduit **36'**.

(36) Plumbing fixture **62** includes a dispensing end **66** which is configured to be fluidly coupled with a receiving end **68** of a conduit **70** that is integrated into spout **20**. Plumbing fixture **62** includes a plurality of threads **72** that are configured to facilitate the mounting of plumbing fixture **62** to a body such as countertop **22**. Plumbing fixture **62** further includes a mounting flange **74** that facilitates the mounting of plumbing fixture **62** to a body, as discussed below.

(37) Mounting assembly **60** assigns the function of mounting a plumbing fixture to a body to mounting portion **64**. Mounting portion **64** has an annular configuration that includes an inner diameter. The inner diameter has a plurality of threads **76** disposed along a surface defining the inner diameter. Plurality of threads **76** are configured to engage plurality of threads **72**. In this manner, mounting portion **64** may be screwed onto the threaded portion of plumbing fixture **62**. Countertop **22** has an opening that defines a hole **78**. In FIG. 6, plumbing fixture **62** is disposed within hole **78** and plurality of threads **76** are in threaded engagement with plurality of threads **72**.

As mounting portion **64** and plumbing fixture **26** are screwed into threaded engagement with one another, mounting portion **64** and mounting flange **74** are pulled towards one another. As mounting portion **64** and mounting flange **74** are pulled towards one another, a lower surface of mounting portion **64** and an upper surface of mounting flange **74** cooperate to compress countertop **22**. In this manner, mounting portion **64** mounts plumbing fixture **62** to countertop **22**.

(38) When spout **20** is coupled with mounting portion **64** after mounting portion **64** has been coupled with plumbing fixture **62**, dispensing end **66** of plumbing fixture **62** is placed in fluid communication with receiving end **68** of spout **20** and a fluid tight conduit is formed that facilitates the delivery of fluid from plumbing fixture **62** to bowl **16**.

(39) Spout **20** includes an opening **80** that extends laterally entirely through an outer wall of spout **20**. Mounting portion **64** includes a cavity **82** that extends laterally into a wall of mounting portion **64**. Cavity **82** is disposed in a position that aligns with opening **80** when spout **20** is coupled with mounting portion **64**. In the illustrated embodiment, a mounting member **84** extends through opening **80** and into cavity **82**. In this manner, mounting member **84** affixes spout **20** to mounting portion **64**. In some embodiments, spout **20** may include a plurality of openings **80** and mounting portion **64** may include a corresponding plurality of cavities **82** that are disposed to align with plurality of openings **80**. In such embodiments, a plurality of mounting members **84** may be employed to affix spout **20** to mounting portion **64**. In some embodiments, mounting member **84** may comprise a threaded fastener, such as a flat head screw, a Phillips head screw, a hex head screw, and the like and either or both opening **80** and cavity **82** may include threads to engage with such threaded fastener. As discussed above, other mounting mechanisms such as, but not limited to, retaining rings, pins or buttons may be employed as an alternative to mounting members **84**.

(40) So long as mounting member **84** remains in place within cavity **82**, spout **20** will remain affixed to mounting portion **64**. If spout **20** ever becomes damaged, corroded, decayed or if for any other reason, an unskilled user decides to change out spout **20** (for example, to install a new spout having a different appearance or ornamental design), then all the unskilled user would need to do is to remove mounting member **84** from cavity **82**. With mounting member **84** removed, spout **20** may be decoupled from mounting portion **64**. When this occurs, mounting portion **64** remains in threaded engagement with plumbing fixture **62** and plumbing fixture **62** remains undisturbed during the changeout or replacement of spout **20**.

(41) With continuing reference to FIGS. 1-6, FIG. 7 is a schematic cross-sectional view illustrating the continued engagement between mounting portion **64** and plumbing fixture **62**, and consequently, the undisturbed mounting of plumbing fixture **62** to countertop **22** after mounting member **84** has been removed and spout **20** has been decoupled from mounting portion **64**. A new spout may now be mounted to mounting portion **64** simply by positioning the new spout over mounting portion **64** and re-inserting mounting member **84**. The various components illustrated in FIG. 7 have been illustrated in a manner that depicts gaps between the components. These gaps have been depicted for ease of illustration to better show the relationship between the components and to better show the contours of the components. It should be understood that in embodiments intended for implementation, the various components would be more tightly drawn up against one another and in some embodiments, would be in direct contact with one another.

(42) The foregoing description of the embodiments has been provided for purposes of illustration and description. It is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the disclosure. Individual elements or features of a particular embodiment are generally not limited to that particular embodiment, but, where applicable, are interchangeable and can be used in a selected embodiment, even if not specifically shown or described. The same may also be varied in many ways. Such variations are not to be regarded as a departure from the disclosure, and all such modifications are intended to be included within the scope of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A mounting assembly for use with a plumbing fixture, the plumbing fixture comprising a conduit associated with a water source, a dispensing end of the plumbing fixture configured to be coupled with the mounting assembly, the plumbing fixture further configured to be mounted within an opening in a body, the mounting assembly comprising: a first portion configured to engage the plumbing fixture, to secure the plumbing fixture within the opening in the body, and to support the plumbing fixture such that the dispensing end of the plumbing fixture protrudes beyond the opening in the body; and a second portion configured to be releasably coupled with the first portion.
2. The mounting assembly of claim 1, wherein the first portion is configured for threaded engagement with the plumbing fixture.
3. The mounting assembly of claim 2, wherein the first portion has an annular configuration having an inner diameter and a plurality of threads defined in the inner diameter, the plurality of threads configured for engagement with a corresponding plurality of threads disposed on an outer diameter of the plumbing fixture.
4. The mounting assembly of claim 1, the plumbing fixture including a mounting feature, wherein the first portion is configured to cooperate with the mounting feature to mount the plumbing fixture to the body when the first portion is engaged with the plumbing fixture while the plumbing fixture is disposed within the opening of the body.
5. The mounting assembly of claim 4, wherein the first portion and the mounting feature are configured to compress against opposite surfaces of the body when the first portion is engaged with the plumbing fixture while the plumbing fixture is disposed within the opening in the body.
6. The mounting assembly of claim 1, wherein the second portion has a decorative appearance.
7. The mounting assembly of claim 1, wherein the second portion is configured to conceal the first portion from view when the second portion is engaged with the first portion while the first portion is engaged with the plumbing fixture while the plumbing fixture is mounted within the opening in the body.
8. The mounting assembly of claim 7, wherein the second portion envelopes the first portion when the second portion is engaged with the first portion while the first portion is engaged with the plumbing fixture while the plumbing fixture is mounted within the opening in the body.
9. The mounting assembly of claim 1, wherein the plumbing fixture comprises a selectively operable water source.
10. The mounting assembly of claim 1, further including a threaded fastener, the threaded fastener configured to releasably couple the first portion and the second portion to one another.
11. The mounting assembly of claim 1, wherein the body comprises a counter configured to receive a sink.
12. The mounting assembly of claim 1, wherein the body comprises a sink surround.
13. A mounting assembly for use with a plumbing fixture, the plumbing fixture configured to be mounted within an opening in a body, the mounting assembly comprising: a first portion configured to engage the plumbing fixture and to secure the plumbing fixture within the opening in the body; a second portion configured to be releasably coupled with the first portion; and a handle, wherein the second portion comprises a bezzel, wherein the handle is configured to operably engage the plumbing fixture and to enable a user to selectively operate the plumbing fixture when the handle is engaged with the plumbing fixture, and is further configured to be rotatably mounted to the second portion.
14. The mounting assembly of claim 13, wherein the first portion is configured for threaded engagement with the plumbing fixture.
15. The mounting assembly of claim 13, the plumbing fixture including a mounting feature,

wherein the first portion is configured to cooperate with the mounting feature to mount the plumbing fixture to the body when the first portion is engaged with the plumbing fixture while the plumbing fixture is disposed within the opening of the body.

16. The mounting assembly of claim 13, wherein the second portion has a decorative appearance.

17. The mounting assembly of claim 13, wherein the second portion is configured to conceal the first portion from view when the second portion is engaged with the first portion while the first portion is engaged with the plumbing fixture while the plumbing fixture is mounted within the opening in the body.

18. The mounting assembly of claim 17, wherein the second portion envelopes the first portion when the second portion is engaged with the first portion while the first portion is engaged with the plumbing fixture while the plumbing fixture is mounted within the opening in the body.

19. The mounting assembly of claim 13, further including a threaded fastener, the threaded fastener configured to releasably couple the first portion and the second portion to one another.

20. A mounting assembly for use with a plumbing fixture, the plumbing fixture comprising a conduit associated with a water source, a dispensing end of the plumbing fixture configured to be coupled with the mounting assembly, the plumbing fixture further configured to be mounted within an opening in a body, the mounting assembly comprising: a first portion configured to engage the plumbing fixture, to secure the plumbing fixture within the opening in the body, and to support the plumbing fixture such that the dispensing end of the plumbing fixture protrudes beyond the opening in the body; and a second portion configured to be releasably coupled with the first portion, wherein the second portion comprise a spout.
